



Has World War III  
Already Begun?

REVIEW

WSJ

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL WEEKEND



Sweaters  
That Aren't  
Sweltering  
OFF DUTY

What's  
News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Meta Platforms is urging** California's attorney general to block OpenAI's planned conversion to a for-profit company, siding with Musk in a battle between Silicon Valley's most powerful artificial-intelligence players. **B9**
- ◆ **McKinsey said it agreed** to accept responsibility for its role in helping Purdue Pharma turbocharge sales of its flagship OxyContin opioid painkiller as the firm entered into a \$650 million settlement with the Justice Department. **B9**
- ◆ **Boeing will invest \$1 billion** in its South Carolina operations to boost production of 787 Dreamliner jets, seeking to address a backlog. **B9**
- ◆ **U.S. stocks fell Friday** in light but broad-based selling. The Dow fell 0.2% and the S&P 500 dropped slightly, while the Nasdaq eked out a 0.1% gain. **B10**
- ◆ **Johnson & Johnson has** sued divisions of health insurer Cigna, accusing them of working with a drug-benefit middleman to drain J&J financial-assistance funds earmarked for patients. **B10**
- ◆ **Cattle prices hit record** highs this past week on concerns about disruptions to beef imports in the U.S. due to potential tariffs and insect infestations. **B10**

World-Wide

- ◆ **The U.S. is preparing** rules that would restrict the sale of advanced artificial-intelligence chips in certain parts of the world in an attempt to limit China's ability to access them. **A1**
- ◆ **Texas is suing** a New York-based doctor for allegedly prescribing abortion pills through telemedicine to a patient from Texas. **A3**
- ◆ **Washington's main ally** in Syria warned that a power vacuum in the country was leading to attacks on the group by Turkish-backed rebels, forcing it to halt its yearslong campaign against Islamic State. **A6**
- ◆ **Nancy Pelosi was** admitted to a hospital for evaluation after being injured in a fall during an overseas trip. **A3**
- ◆ **The Biden administration** agreed to extend and modify an agreement with China on cooperation in science and technology. **A6**
- ◆ **Jan. 6 defendants** have grown newly strident in their criminal cases as they wait for Trump to deliver on his pledge to pardon supporters charged in connection with the attack. **A3**
- ◆ **A Chinese businessman** with links to Prince Andrew has been banned from entering the U.K. **A8**
- ◆ **French President Emmanuel Macron** appointed François Bayrou, a seasoned centrist, as prime minister. **A6**

NOONAN

Biden gets lost in  
Trump's shadow **A13**

|                          |                      |
|--------------------------|----------------------|
| CONTENTS                 | Obituaries..... C6   |
| Books..... C7-12         | Opinion..... A11-13  |
| Business & Finance B9    | Sports..... A10      |
| Food..... D8,10          | Style & Fashion D2-4 |
| Gear & Gadgets..... D11  | Travel..... D6-7     |
| Heard on Street..... B11 | U.S. News..... A2-4  |
| Markets & Finance B10    | World News..... A6-8 |



Syrians Rejoice Despite Their Uncertain Future



**CELEBRATION:** People gathered in the main square of Damascus for the first Friday Muslim prayers since Bashar al-Assad's fall, while Secretary of State Antony Blinken tried to shore up regional support for a transitional government in Syria. **A6**

Tracking Putin's Feared Secret Agency,  
From Inside a Russian Prison and Beyond

The spy unit that arrested a Wall Street Journal reporter is leading the biggest campaign of internal repression since the demise of Joseph Stalin

By EVAN GERSHKOVICH  
With Drew Hinshaw, Joe Parkinson and Thomas Grove

**A**BOARD A RUSSIAN PRESIDENTIAL JET  
The spy at the front of the cabin drew open the curtain.  
Wearing a sand-colored jacket and brown shoes, with a salt-and-pepper goatee, the man had spent the past few hours organizing the final preparations for the largest East-West prisoner swap since the Cold War. Now, as the pilots started the engines to take off for an airport in Turkey's capital, he came out to look at the 16 prisoners he was escorting to freedom, a haul of Americans, Russians and Germans in their first hours fresh from jails and penal colonies. Scanning the passengers, he locked his eyes squarely on one of those prisoners—me. He said nothing, staring in silence for nearly a minute. Then he turned and walked back to his curtained-off section of the presidential



**Lt. Gen. Dmitry Minaev,**  
caught on video during  
Aug. 1 prisoner transfer.

jet. I was left to wonder about this man at the helm of the exchange, who appeared to hold my fate in his hands.  
When I was arrested by Russia's security forces in 2023—the first foreign correspondent charged with espionage since the Cold War—I never stopped reporting. On my release I set out to identify the man who had taken me, and to learn more about the spy unit that had carried out his orders.  
During my 16 months' imprisonment, colleagues at The Wall Street Journal had been asking parallel questions.  
Together, we have identified the man behind the curtain as Lt. Gen. Dmitry Minaev and can now reveal a trove of fresh details about the unit that he runs: the Department for Counterintelligence Operations. Known as DKRO, it is at the very core of Russian President Vladimir Putin's opaque wartime regime. The story of how it got there reveals much about how Russia's autocratic system became entangled in a broiling con-

Please turn to page A9

Mother  
Searched  
Fruitlessly  
For Suspect

BALTIMORE—Before Kathy Mangione became known as the mother of a suspected assassin, she was just a parent looking for her son.

By Scott Calvert,  
Valerie Bauerlein  
and Jim Carlton

She had desperately searched for 26-year-old Luigi Mangione for the better part of a year, according to people close to the family. One said that he “went off the grid six months to a year ago and wasn't communicating with anybody,” and that his distraught mother was doing all she could to find him. Another said the Ivy League engineering graduate was “MIA for about eight months.”  
When Luigi Mangione finally resurfaced Monday, it was under the grimmest of circumstances—as the accused killer of UnitedHealthcare Chief Executive Brian Thompson in New York City and an alleged fugitive whose five-

Please turn to page A4

After Staying Arm's-Length,  
CEOs Now Cozy Up to Trump

By Brian Schwartz,  
Dana Mattioli  
and Rebecca Ballhaus

When Donald Trump arrived at the New York Stock Exchange this past week for a postelection victory lap, dozens of influential executives lined up for a glimpse of the man who holds the future of their businesses in his hands.  
Gathered behind red velvet ropes were senior executives from Visa, Meta Platforms, Goldman Sachs, Charles Schwab and Citadel, according

to people present. Real-estate and aerospace magnate Robert Bigelow was spotted, as was investor Bill Ackman.  
“The economy, I believe, is going to be very strong,” said Trump, standing in front of a portrait of himself on the

cover of Time magazine, which this past week named him its person of the year.  
Corporate America is hoping Trump is right—but isn't leaving anything to chance.  
Titans of the business world are rushing to make inroads with the president-elect, gambling that personal relationships with the next occupant of the Oval Office will help

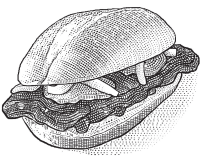
Please turn to page A2

A Pork Sandwich Returns  
To Play Tricks on Fans' Minds

McRib lovers take the bait every time  
McDonald's rolls it out for a farewell tour

By ROSHAN FERNANDEZ

When McDonald's says it's the last chance to get a McRib, Francis Kulp knows he might be getting played. But with the polarizing pork sandwich, he leaves nothing to chance.  
The 73-year-old buys about



Teasing season

a dozen extra McRibs, wraps each individually in plastic and stores them in his freezer.  
Kulp starts working through them a month or two after McRib season ends. He says they still taste good, though he removes the pickles because those don't reheat  
Please turn to page A4

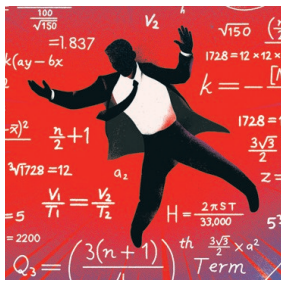
TikTok Star's Small Role  
Is Big for Broadway Show

By ASHLEY WONG

In late October, an unexpected face joined the cast of Broadway musical “& Juliet”: Charli D'Amelio, one of TikTok's biggest stars.  
A trained dancer whose choreographed routines catapulted her to fame on the platform, D'Amelio is instantly recognizable to most people under the age of 30. The 20-year-old has 155 million followers on TikTok, making her the app's second-most-fol-

lowed personality. She has helped market sugary Dunkin' cold brews, anchored a Kardashians-style reality show about her family and won “Dancing With the Stars.” Can she sell theater tickets?  
D'Amelio isn't the star of “& Juliet”; she's an ensemble member with no lines. Still, since her Oct. 29 debut, the average dollar amount of tickets sold for all performances of the show in a single day has gone up by about 17%  
Please turn to page A8

EXCHANGE



AD REVOLUTION

A merger of titans lays bare the data and tech in advertising. **B1**